

JUSTIFICATION FOR OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION

SECTION 1: IDENTIFICATION OF THE AGENCY AND THE CONTRACTING ACTIVITY

- **Department of State**
- **Overseas Post:** U.S. Embassy Bujumbura
- **Requiring Activity:** Purchase of New Isuzu Flatbed Trucks for Light-Duty Use

SECTION 2: NATURE AND/OR DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED

Approval is requested to solicit and award a contract on a **Brand Name Only** basis for the procurement of two (2) Isuzu flatbed trucks to meet the operational and logistical needs of the U.S. Embassy Bujumbura.

SECTION 3: DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES REQUIRED TO MEET THE AGENCY'S NEEDS

The following vehicles are required:

Isuzu Flatbed Truck (Light-Duty Use)

- **Engine:** 2.8L or 3.0L Diesel, 4-cylinder Turbo
- **Transmission:** 5-speed manual or 6-speed automatic
- **Drivetrain:** Rear-wheel drive (RWD) with optional 4WD
- **Seating Capacity:** 2-3 seats (standard cab) or 5-6 seats (double cabin – optional if available)
- **Payload Capacity:** Minimum 3,000 kg
- **Flatbed Dimensions:** Minimum 12 ft length, reinforced steel frame
- **Fuel Tank Capacity:** 75 liters minimum
- **Tires:** Standard heavy-duty tires for mixed terrain
- **Additional Features:** Basic air conditioning, durable fabric seats, standard safety features including ABS and airbags

SECTION 4: IDENTIFICATION OF THE STATUTORY AUTHORITY PERMITTING OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION

This acquisition is conducted under the authority of **FAR 6.302-1(c) – Brand Name Only**, which allows for limiting competition to a specific brand name while still permitting competition among resellers of that brand.

SECTION 5: JUSTIFICATION FOR THE BRAND NAME REQUIREMENT

The U.S. Embassy Bujumbura requires **Isuzu flatbed trucks specifically** for the following reasons:

- **Fleet Standardization:** The embassy's existing fleet primarily consists of Isuzu trucks, ensuring compatibility in terms of maintenance, spare parts, and operational use. Introducing a different brand would require new training, specialized tools, and increased inventory costs for spare parts.
- **Proven Reliability in Harsh Conditions:** Isuzu trucks have demonstrated durability in Bujumbura's operational environment. Their performance history ensures reduced downtime and lower maintenance costs.
- **Local Service and Parts Availability:** Isuzu has an established network of authorized service providers in the region, ensuring faster repairs and minimal operational disruption. Other brands may lack the same level of support locally.
- **Cost Efficiency:** Using a uniform brand reduces procurement, maintenance, and training costs compared to maintaining a mixed fleet with varying requirements.

SECTION 6: DESCRIPTION OF EFFORTS TO ENSURE MAXIMUM COMPETITION

While the requirement is for **Isuzu-branded trucks**, the solicitation will be posted publicly, allowing multiple suppliers, dealerships, and authorized resellers to compete for the contract. This ensures fair competition among vendors who can provide Isuzu trucks that meet the specifications.

SECTION 7: DETERMINATION OF FAIR AND REASONABLE COST

The Contracting Officer has determined that the anticipated cost to the Government is fair and reasonable based on:

- **Historical pricing of similar Isuzu models** purchased by other U.S. government agencies.
- **Market research on comparable vehicles**, which confirmed that Isuzu trucks provide the best value in terms of durability and long-term maintenance costs.
- **Quotes from multiple authorized dealers**, ensuring competitive pricing.

SECTION 8: MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED

Market research was conducted within the past 12 months to identify available truck models that meet the operational needs of the U.S. Embassy Bujumbura.

- **Findings:** While several manufacturers produce similar flatbed trucks, the operational benefits of using Isuzu—such as fleet uniformity, lower maintenance costs, and local support—make it the most suitable choice.
- **Alternative Brands Considered:** Other truck manufacturers, such as Toyota and Mitsubishi, were reviewed. However, these brands would require additional training, tools, and spare part inventories, increasing overall costs.

SECTION 9: OTHER FACTORS SUPPORTING THE BRAND NAME JUSTIFICATION

- **Operational Consistency:** The embassy staff is already trained in handling Isuzu vehicles, making integration seamless.
- **Faster Deployment:** Since spare parts and mechanics are already familiar with Isuzu, acquiring these trucks will ensure a smooth transition without additional costs or delays.

SECTION 10: SOURCES THAT EXPRESSED INTEREST

Not applicable at this stage; competition will be conducted among authorized Isuzu dealers.

SECTION 11: FUTURE ACTIONS TO PROMOTE COMPETITION

The embassy will continue monitoring the market for alternative vehicles and conduct periodic assessments to determine whether future procurements should allow for broader competition.

I have determined, in accordance with FAR 13.106-1(b)(1), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a brand name is reasonably available.

Rene Davy Ntore
Motor Pool Supervisor

RD

11 April 2025

The above justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

1 April 2025


Jamie M. Fleischhacker
Contracting Officer